

Zoho Applications: Free vs. Paid Comparison

A comprehensive guide to key application features, free plan limits, and paid tier upgrades.

CORE APPLICATIONS SUITE

APPLICATION	FREE USER CAP	KEY FEATURES INCLUDED (FREE)	MAIN FREE PLAN LIMITATIONS	KEY FEATURES UNLOCKED ON PAID PLANS
Zoho CRM	Up to 3 users	Leads, contacts, deals, tasks, 5,000 records, mobile app access	Strict 3 user limit; 1 GB total storage limit	Workflow automation, mass email, custom reports & dashboards, AI (Zia), full API access
Zoho Mail	Up to 5 users	Custom domain email hosting, webmail access, 5 GB storage/user	No IMAP/POP sync for desktop clients (web browser & mobile app only)	IMAP/POP3 desktop client access, 50 GB–100 GB storage per user, email routing/retention
Zoho Books	1 user + 1 accountant	Invoicing, expense tracking, bank reconciliation, offline payments	\$50k annual revenue limit cap; no automated workflow triggers	Multiple users, vendor bills, inventory tracking, multi-currency support, custom fields
Zoho Projects	Up to 3 users	Up to 2 active projects, task management, basic Gantt charts	Strict limit of 2 projects; 10 MB file attachment storage limit	Unlimited active projects, issue tracking, project templates, subtasks, custom fields
Zoho Desk	Up to 3 agents	Ticket management, basic help center knowledge base, email tickets	No automated rules/routing, limited support interaction channels	Multi-department routing, SLA management, automated ticket workflows, telephony integration
Zoho Forms	1 user	3 active forms, 500 form submissions/month	No payment processor integrations, no advanced workflow rules	Unlimited forms, higher submission limits, payment gateways (Stripe/PayPal), custom PDF design
Zoho Campaigns	1 user	Up to 2,000 contacts, 6,000 emails/month	Mandatory Zoho branding on emails; basic standard reports only	Unlimited email sends, automated email workflows, list segmentation, dynamic content
Zoho Cliq	Unlimited users	Real-time chat, channels, 100 GB total team storage	Limited message search history; capped file attachment sizes	Extended storage capacity, custom bots & integrations, unlimited screen sharing recordings
Zoho Inventory	1 user	50 shipping labels/orders per month, 1 warehouse location	Strict monthly order volume limit	Serial & batch tracking, multi-warehouse support, automated order routing
Zoho Analytics	Up to 2 users	10,000 rows of data, basic reports & dashboards	Capped data row size; manual data refreshes only	Millions of rows support, automated data connectors, scheduled reports, SQL querying
Zoho Invoice	Unlimited users	Complete invoicing, expense tracking, time tracking	None (100% Free Application — No paid tier exists)	Fully Featured (Includes all capabilities for small businesses)

PLATFORM-WIDE UPGRADES ACROSS ALL APPS

1. Automation & Workflows

Free plans require manual actions. Paid plans unlock trigger-based workflow rules, webhooks, and automated email sequences.

2. API & Integrations

Free tiers restrict API credits and third-party tools. Paid tiers provide full API endpoints and webhooks.

3. User Expansion

Free tiers enforce strict hard caps (1–5 users). Paid plans allow scaling seats across teams seamlessly.

4. Branding & Customization

Free tiers carry "Powered by Zoho" branding. Paid plans allow full white-labeling and custom domains.

5. Direct Support

Free accounts rely on forums and documentation. Paid plans include 24/5 or 24/7 phone, chat, and email support.

Note: For businesses needing multiple paid apps, **Zoho One** offers an all-in-one license giving enterprise-level access to 50+ Zoho apps under a single subscription.